



ANNIVERSARY

→ babble on these literal, chatterboxes all day long without worrying about the charge or connection dropping off in the juiciest part of the conversation. Landlines are particularly cumbersome to install, with regards to the amount of infrastructure that needs to be in place before a single premises in a vicinity can boast of having a telephone lying around. But they do bring the benefit of making available reasonably fast internet connections with ADSL to areas where the mobile carriers are not able to setup high speed wireless connectivity.

CRTs

You will usually find these big, hulking beasts quietly humming away their time in dingy back offices, government department and at homes they're relegated to



Glory days!

the bedroom with the shiny new LED TV adorning the living room. The display technologies available in the market today have just been able to catch up with the excellent

color reproduction and a large color gamut that CRTs have boasted for long. Even now very few screens offer the black levels as deep as the ones offered by CRT display. Other benefits that CRTs have up for grabs include lack of any native (max) resolution that most modern screens come with, it's the only display technology that is capable of true multisyncing - displaying multiple resolutions and refresh rates without scaling. There is nearly non-existent input lag and the response time is much better compared to LCDs. CRTs also have excellent viewing angles, so you can enjoy the game from any part of the couch. What is working against this technology is - the weight of such displays, inability to scale in size and the supposed dangers of radiation (electrons) emanated by the eponymous cathode ray tube..

Tech that got lost along the way

In the normal course of things, one of two things can happen to a particular technology: either it becomes obsolete and dies out or it gives rise to another technology that ends up cannibalising the parent technology. But sometimes, tech gets lost to the sands of time for no explicable reason. Inventions, processes and technologies of antiquity have disappeared with the passage of time instead of being passed down from generation to generation. They are so anomalous that till date scientists haven't been able to replicate or explain exactly how these things worked.

The Antikythera Mechanism

In the early 1900s divers off the coast of the Greek island of Antikythera dis-

covered remnants of a startling bronze machine. Dated back to the first century BC, it consisted of over 30 gears, cranks, and dials that seemed way more advanced than the technology of that era was thought to support. The device



Does this look two thousand years old?

came to be known as the Antikythera Mechanism and it's true purpose still remains shrouded in mystery.

But it is believed that the device was used to calculate lunar phases and the astronomical positions of celestial bodies. The mechanism is complex enough for it to be called the first true analog computer ever made.

The components are so precise and well made, the Antikythera machine enthusiasts believe there were other machines (replicas if you will) of it's kind prevalent during that time. So what happened to this tech?

Why do the first official records of such complex machines date back only to the 1400s? The answer is that this tech was lost for over a thousand years.